

Migration Project Management

PMO Templates, RACI & Stakeholder Communication

A 200-VM migration is a \$500K+ infrastructure project. It needs a PM, a plan, and communication. This guide provides PMO-ready templates: project charter, RACI matrix, risk register, communication plan, status report templates, and milestone tracking. Copy, customize, execute.

Project Charter | RACI Matrix | Risk Register | Communication Plan | Status Reports | Milestone Tracking

Project Charter

Executive-approved document that authorizes the migration project.

Project Overview

- **Project Name:** VMware to KVM Infrastructure Migration
- **Sponsor:** CTO / VP Infrastructure
- **PM:** Migration Project Manager
- **Start Date:** [Date]
- **Target Completion:** [Date + 12 weeks]
- **Budget:** \$[X] (hardware + labor + contingency)

Business Case: Eliminate \$[X]/yr VMware licensing costs by migrating [N] VMs to open-source KVM. Broadcom acquisition has increased licensing costs by [X]% with [X]-year lock-in commitment required. Migration eliminates vendor dependency and reduces annual infrastructure costs by [X]%.

Scope & Success Criteria

- **In Scope:**
 - Migrate [N] VMs from VMware ESXi to KVM
 - Deploy [N] KVM hosts with HA clustering
 - Configure monitoring, backup, and DR
 - Decommission VMware infrastructure
 -
- **Out of Scope:**
 - Application refactoring or containerization
 - Hardware refresh (using existing or planned servers)
 -
- **Success Criteria:**
 - 100% VMs migrated with < 4 hours total downtime per VM
 - Performance within 10% of VMware baseline
 - All compliance requirements maintained
 - VMware licenses terminated by [date]

Key Milestones

MS#	Milestone	Target Date	Deliverable	Owner	Status
MS1	Project kickoff & assessment	Week 1	VM inventory, risk assessment	PM	
MS2	Infrastructure ready	Week 3	KVM hosts deployed, tested	Infra Lead	
MS3	POC complete (5 VMs)	Week 4	5 VMs migrated, validated	Migration Lead	
MS4	Wave 1 complete (dev/test)	Week 6	Dev/test VMs migrated	Migration Lead	
MS5	Wave 2 complete (production)	Week 9	Production VMs migrated	Migration Lead	
MS6	VMware decommission	Week 11	ESXi hosts powered off	Infra Lead	

RACI Matrix

Who is Responsible, Accountable, Consulted, and Informed for each activity.

Migration RACI

Activity	Executive Sponsor	PM	Infra Lead	Migration Eng	Network Eng	App Owner	DBA	Security
Approve project charter	A	R	C	I	I	I	I	C
VM inventory & assessment	I	A	R	R	C	C	C	I
Risk assessment	I	A	R	C	C	C	C	R
Hardware procurement	A	R	R	I	C	I	I	I
KVM host deployment	I	I	A	R	C	I	I	C
Network configuration	I	I	C	C	A/R	I	I	C
VM conversion (h2kvmctl)	I	I	C	A/R	I	I	I	I
Application validation	I	I	I	C	I	A/R	R	I
Production cutover	I	A	R	R	R	R	R	C
Security compliance verify	I	I	C	I	I	I	I	A/R
VMware decommission	I	A	R	R	I	I	I	I
Post-migration review	C	A/R	C	C	C	C	C	C

R = Responsible (does the work) | A = Accountable (approves/owns) | C = Consulted (provides input) | I = Informed (kept updated)

Risk Register

Identify, assess, and mitigate risks before they become issues.

ID	Risk	Prob	Impact	Score	Mitigation	Contingency	Owner
R1	VM boot failure after conversion	Medium	High	12	h2kvmctl --fix-all; test in pre-prod first	Rollback to VMware VM	Migration Eng
R2	Application incompatibility	Low	High	8	App owner smoke tests; POC with each app type	Keep specific VMs on VMware	App Owner
R3	Performance degradation	Low	Medium	4	Performance baseline before/after; NUMA tuning	CPU pin, hugepages, VirtIO tuning	Infra Lead
R4	Extended downtime during cutover	Medium	High	12	Pre-convert VMs; cutover = shutdown+boot only	Rollback: power on VMware VM	PM
R5	Network connectivity issues	Medium	Medium	9	Map VLANs/bridges before; preserve MACs	Keep VMware running for 48hr	Network Eng
R6	Team skill gap (KVM)	High	Medium	12	Training in weeks 1-2; document all procedures	Engage KVM consultant	PM
R7	Storage capacity insufficient	Low	Medium	4	Right-size + QCOW2 compression; doctor checks space	Add NVMe drives (2-day lead)	Infra Lead
R8	Broadcom contract deadline	High	High	16	Aggressive timeline; prioritize by license expiry	Month-to-month extension	Sponsor
R9	Data loss during migration	Very Low	Critical	8	SHA-256 checksums; keep VMware VMs 48hr; backups	Restore from backup	Migration Eng
R10	Stakeholder resistance	Medium	Medium	9	Executive sponsorship; clear comms; demonstrate POC	Escalate to sponsor	PM

Scoring: Probability (1-4) × Impact (1-4). Red ≥ 12, Yellow 8-11, Green ≤ 7. Review weekly in project standup.

Communication Plan

Who gets told what, when, and how — critical for stakeholder alignment.

Communication Matrix

Audience	Message	Frequency	Channel	Owner	Template
Executive Sponsor	Project status, budget, risks, decisions needed	Bi-weekly	Email + meeting	PM	Executive Status Report (1-pager)
Steering Committee	Milestone progress, major risks, scope changes	Monthly	Meeting (30 min)	PM	Steering Committee Deck (5 slides)
Project Team	Sprint tasks, blockers, daily coordination	Daily standup	Slack + standup	PM	Standup template (3 questions)
App Owners	Migration schedule for their VMs, testing windows	Per-wave	Email + calendar	Migration Lead	Migration Notice (per-wave email)
End Users	Planned maintenance windows, what to expect	Per-cutover	Email blast	PM	Maintenance Notification
Security Team	Compliance status, scan results, findings	Per-wave	ITSM ticket	Security	Compliance Checkpoint Report
Vendor (Broadcom)	License termination notice	Once	Formal letter	Procurement	Termination Notice Template

Status Report Template

Weekly Status Report

PROJECT STATUS REPORT
Week of: [Date]
Overall Status: [GREEN/YELLOW/RED]

PROGRESS:

- VMs migrated: 45/200 (22.5%)
- Current wave: Wave 2 (Production DBs)
- On schedule: YES / NO

ACCOMPLISHMENTS THIS WEEK:

- Completed Wave 1 (35 dev/test VMs)

Migration Wave Notice (Email Template)

Subject: [ACTION] VM Migration Wave 2 –
Saturday March 29, 02:00-06:00

Dear [App Owner],

Your VMs are scheduled for migration from VMware to KVM this Saturday.

AFFECTED VMs:

- db-primary (PostgreSQL)
- db-replica (PostgreSQL)

- All boot tests passed (100%)
- Performance baselines met

PLANNED NEXT WEEK:

- Wave 2 kickoff (25 database VMs)
- Saturday cutover window 02:00-06:00
- App owner sign-offs due Friday

RISKS & ISSUES:

- [R6] Team training gap on Ceph – scheduling workshop for Wednesday
- [ISSUE] NFS mount slow – investigating

DECISIONS NEEDED:

- Approve Wave 2 cutover window
- Budget approval for 4th KVM host

- app-server-01

MAINTENANCE WINDOW:

Saturday March 29, 02:00-06:00 UTC

Expected downtime per VM: 5-15 minutes

WHAT TO EXPECT:

- VMs will be shut down, converted, and restarted on new KVM infrastructure
- IP addresses preserved (no DNS changes)
- All data preserved (checksum verified)

YOUR ACTION REQUIRED:

- Verify application functionality by Monday 12:00 (sign-off form attached)
- Report issues to #migration-support Slack

ROLLBACK:

- If issues found, VMs can be reverted to VMware within 48 hours

Contact: [Migration Lead] | Slack: #migration

Project Timeline

12-week migration project plan for 200 VMs.

Gantt-Style Timeline

Phase / Task	W1	W2	W3	W4	W5	W6	W7	W8	W9	W10	W11	W12	Owner	
Phase 1: Plan	■	■											PM	
VM inventory	■												Infra	
Risk assessment	■												PM	
Team training			■	■									PM	
Phase 2: Build				■	■								Infra	
Deploy KVM hosts				■									Infra	
POC (5 VMs)					■								Migration	
Phase 3: Migrate						■	■	■	■	■				Migration
Wave 1: Dev/Test (35)						■	■							Migration
Wave 2: Databases (25)								■						Migration
Wave 3: Apps (80)									■	■				Migration
Wave 4: Web/Other (60)										■				Migration
Phase 4: Close											■	■	■	PM
VMware decommission												■		Infra
PIR & close													■	PM

Budget Template

Migration project budget breakdown with ROI calculation.

Project Budget (200 VMs)

Category	Estimated	Actual	Notes
Hardware			
KVM servers (5x Dell R760)	\$125,000		64-core, 512GB, 30TB NVMe each
Network switches (2x 25GbE)	\$15,000		ToR switches with VLAN trunking
Cabling & rack accessories	\$3,000		Fiber, patch panels, PDU
Labor			
Project manager (12 weeks)	\$36,000		0.5 FTE @ \$150K/yr
Migration engineers (2x, 8 weeks)	\$48,000		2 FTE @ \$130K/yr for 8 weeks
Network engineer (4 weeks)	\$12,000		0.5 FTE @ \$130K/yr for 4 weeks
Training			
KVM/Linux administration (3 staff)	\$9,000		Red Hat RH318 or equivalent
Software			
hyper2kvm	\$0	\$0	Apache-2.0 open source
RHEL subscriptions (optional)	\$13,000/yr		Or \$0 with Rocky/Alma Linux
Contingency (10%)	\$26,100		Reserve for unforeseen issues
TOTAL PROJECT BUDGET	\$287,100		
Annual VMware savings	\$381,000/yr		vSphere + vSAN + NSX + vCenter
ROI payback period	9 months		Budget / annual savings

A Well-Managed Migration Project Pays for Itself in 9 Months

Use these templates to run a professional migration project. The charter gets executive buy-in, RACI prevents confusion, risk register prevents surprises, and communication plan keeps everyone aligned. 200 VMs in 12 weeks is achievable with 2 migration engineers using h2kvmctl automation. The \$287K investment saves \$381K in Year 1 alone — a 133% ROI.